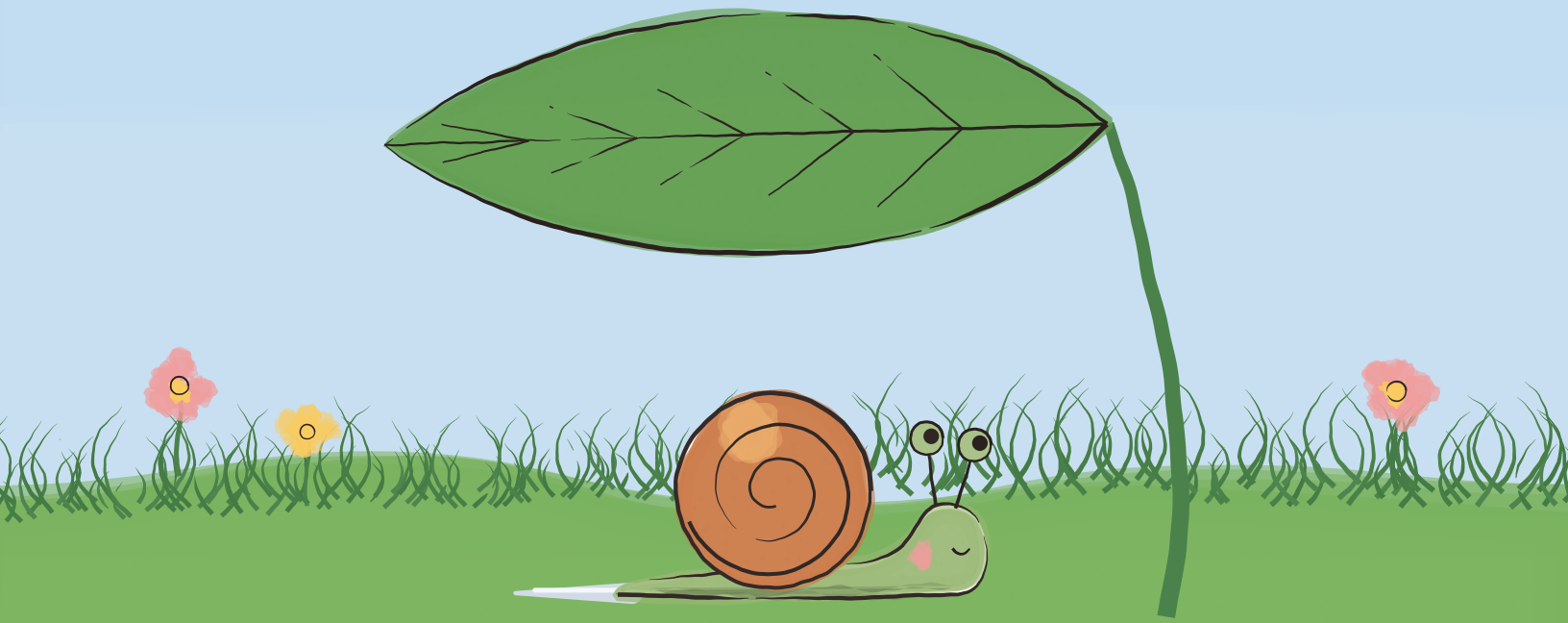
Moss Goes to the Sea

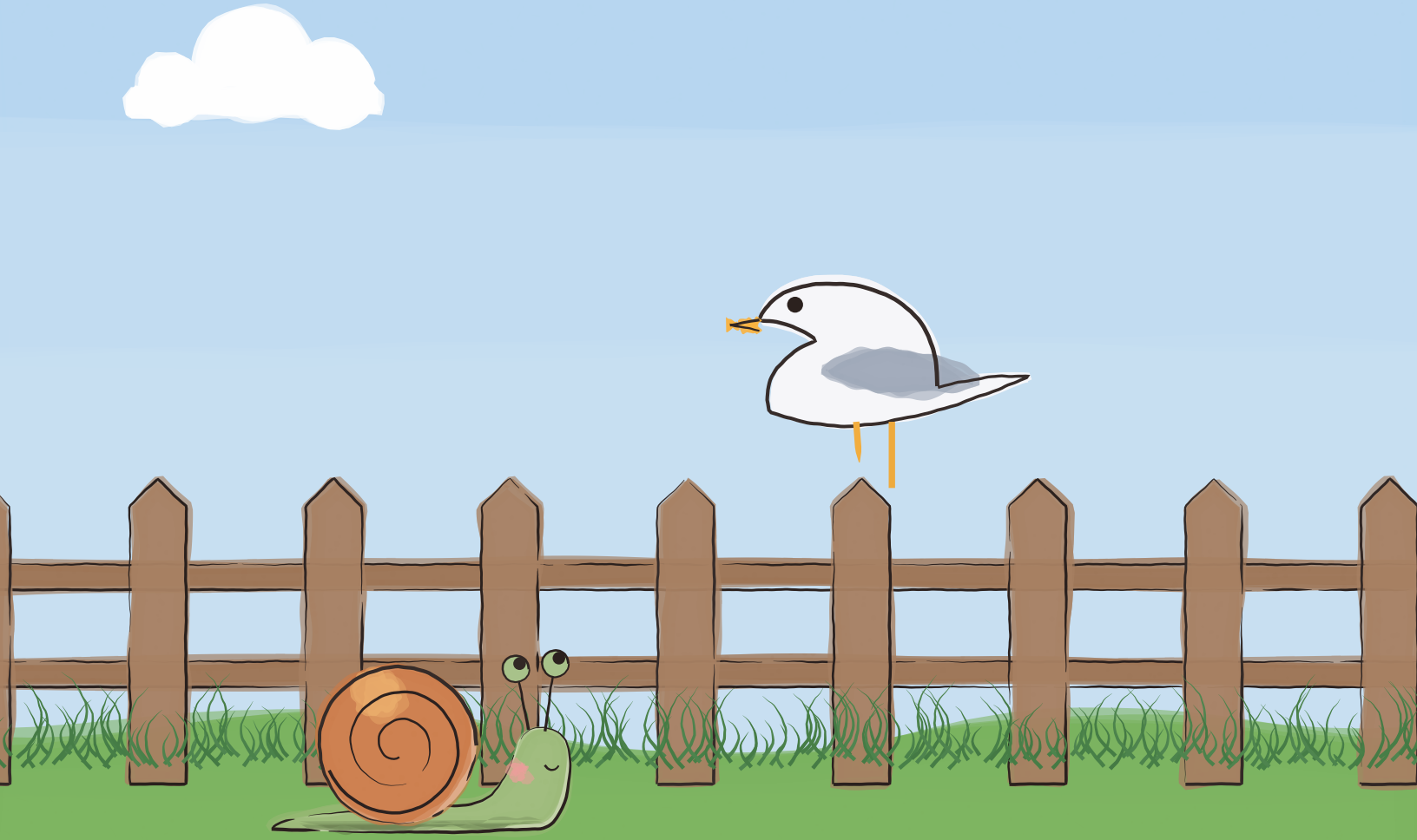
a picture book painted in PostScript



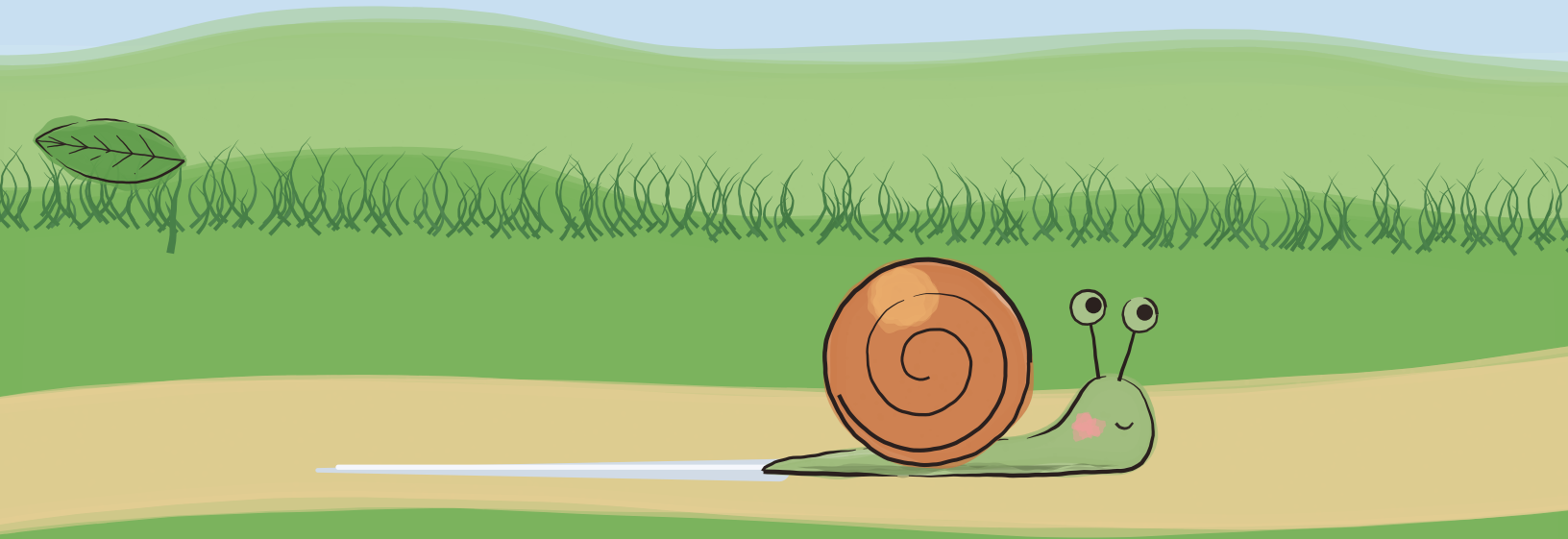
In a corner of the garden, under a big green leaf,
lived a small snail named Moss.



One morning a gull landed on the fence.
"I have just come from the sea," said the gull. "It is big and blue, and all day long it sings."

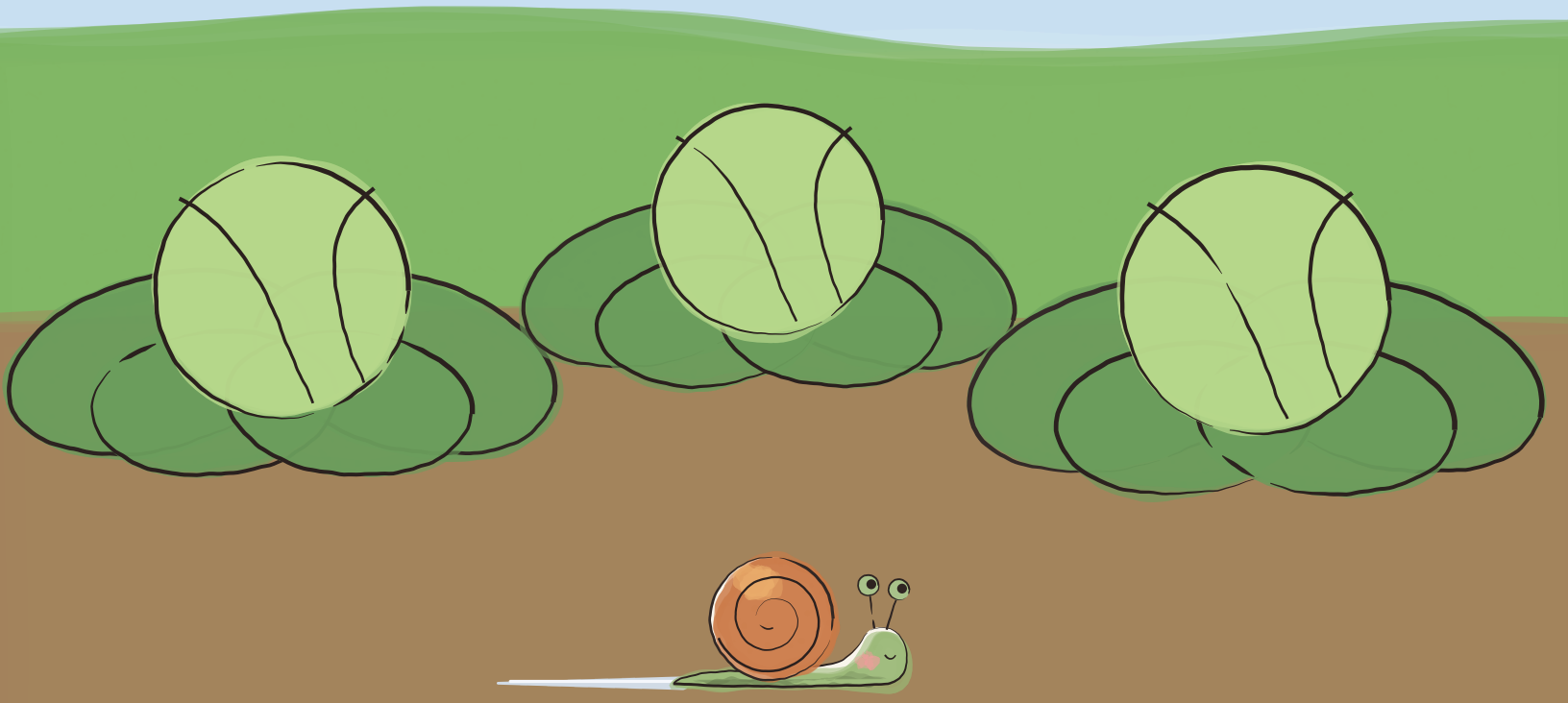


“I would like to hear the sea sing,” said Moss.
So she packed nothing at all, because a snail
carries her house with her, and off she went.



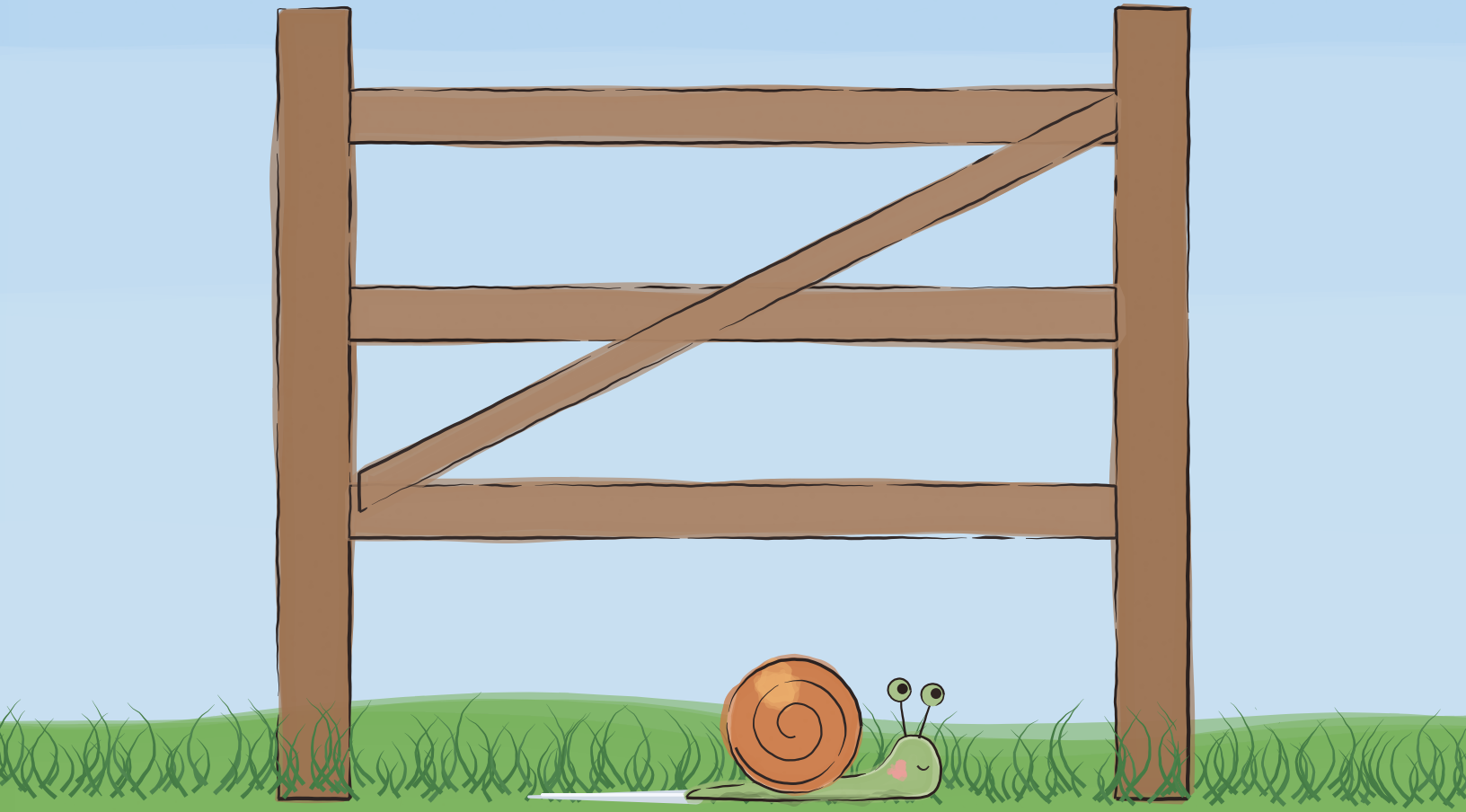
She went past the cabbages.

Slowly.



She went under the gate.

Slowly.



She went through the meadow, where the grass was as tall as trees.

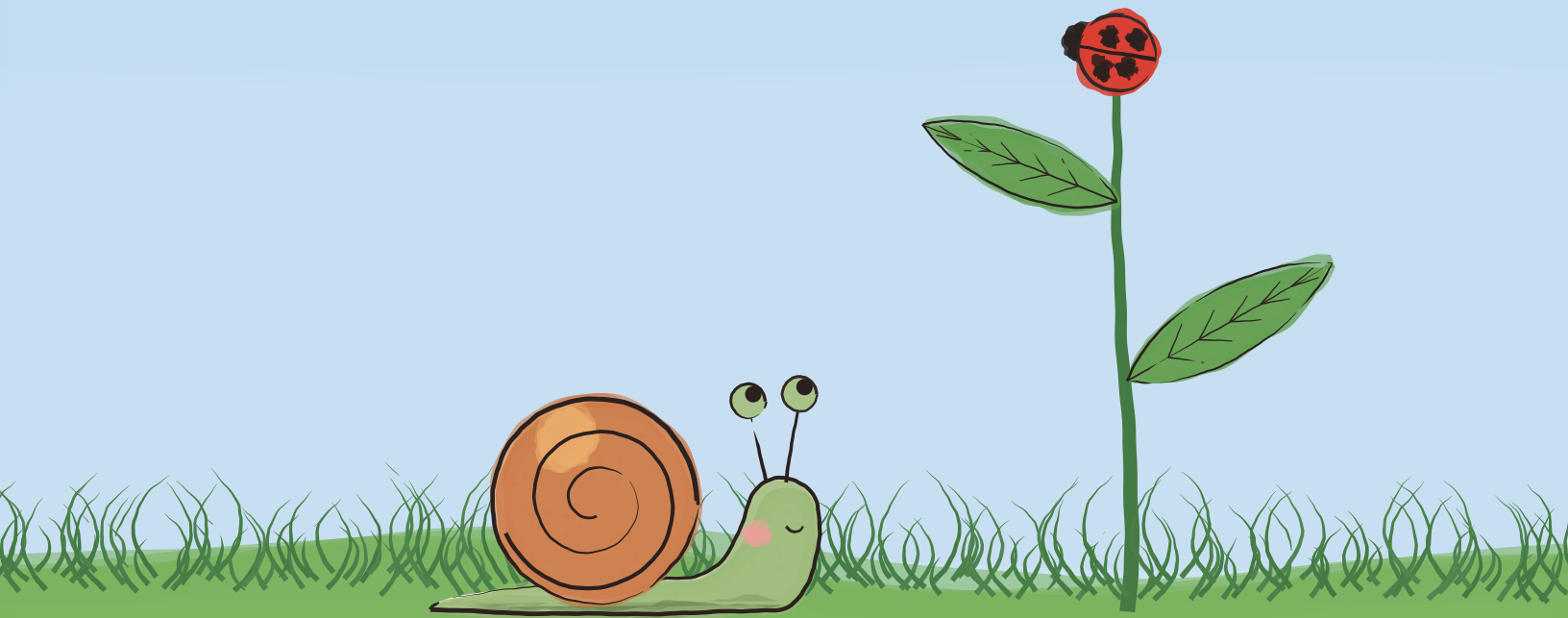
Slowly, slowly.



Then it began to rain.
Moss did not mind one bit. Snails like rain.



“Where are you going?” asked a ladybird.
“To hear the sea sing,” said Moss.
“That is very far for a snail,” said the ladybird.
“Then I will go very far,” said Moss.



The sun went down. The stars came out.
Moss kept going.



At last the grass turned to sand, and the sand ran all the way down to the water.



There was the sea, big and silver under the moon.
And it sang:

hush . . . hush . . . hush.



Moss listened until her eyes grew heavy.



Then she curled up inside her shell, the way snails do. And there, in her own small house, she could still hear the sea singing:

hush . . . hush . . . hush.



The End



Moss Goes to the Sea. Written, painted and set in PostScript, rendered with pscat.
An ArtColony project: github.com/ArtColony/childrens_book